

Promoting EDI at Conferences

Conferences are critical platforms for sharing knowledge, fostering collaboration, and shaping the future of our field. Ensuring equity, diversity, and inclusion (EDI) improves representation, enhances innovation, and creates a welcoming environment for all.

Key Challenges

- **Representation:** Lack of diversity in committees, speakers, and participants limits perspectives
- **Accessibility:** Financial barriers, visa challenges, and caregiving responsibilities prevent participation
- **Engagement:** Inaccessible talks and exclusive social events exclude certain attendees

Actionable Steps



Organizing the Event

- Form diverse organizing committees to ensure broad perspectives.
- Provide early acceptance notifications for visas, choose locations with simplified visa processes, and/or offer hybrid participation options
- Allocate funds for caregivers, nursing spaces, and travel support.
- Share logistics (accessibility details, timetables) before registration
- Pair early-career researchers with mentors for career guidance.
- Design inclusive social events with non-alcoholic options + quiet spaces.



Accessibility & Inclusion in Sessions

- Presentations:
 - Ensure physically accessible venue locations and seating arrangements.
 - Use microphones and introduce yourself as a speaker.
 - Keep slides simple and clear, avoiding complex jargon.
 - Use digital pointers to accommodate light sensitivities.
- During Q&A:
 - Create space for underrepresented voices.
 - Allow reflection time and provide flexible question formats.
 - Ensure easy microphone access with 'mic runners'.
- Breakout sessions/working groups:
 - Assign distinct roles to balance responsibilities.
 - Clarify publication processes for any outputs.



Post-event Follow-up:

- Collect feedback to identify areas for improvement.
- Track and analyze diversity statistics for participants and speakers.



See link for additional
& updated guides